

Radius

Trinity Ball

From chatting to headline acts to exploring the ball's fashion history, Radius provides an in-depth look at the evolution of the most hotly anticipated event of the year.

OP-ED

Advantages of Brexit

Tom Boland, former head of the Higher Education Authority, argues that universities have a unique role to play in Irish society in light of Brexit, and that they may be able to reap rewards in **opinion**, **page 11**»

INFOCUS

Students and the Eighth

Emma-Louise Nolan looks at the history of student campaigning on abortion, from fighting to distribute information to today's campaign to repeal the eighth amendment in **features**, **page 9**»

Magazine

Investigating the French elections, a portrait of a divided country



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Student Publication of the Year

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Students' Unions to Legislate for Independence

Sinéad Baker
EDITOR

In response to “ever-increasing encroachments” on their independence from institutions and a feeling of being unable to act, campaign and budget freely, students’ unions across Ireland are in the early stages of attempting to legislate to ensure their autonomy. While many students’ unions maintain a mutually agreed system of independence from their institutions, several are not considered autonomous, and thus have to justify expenses. Others, because of an undefined relationship with their institution, find that their independence is being eroded. As such, momentum is now growing for a national campaign that would leave

students’ unions answerable to the students they represent, and not the institutions they work with. Unions from around the country have already come together to meet with legal representation to begin the process of drafting legislation, which would see institutions unable to threaten students’ unions with actions like withholding funding, preventing them from hosting certain events or campaigning on particular issues. Speaking to *The University Times*, Richard Hammond, of Hammond Good Solicitors, who also serves as the lawyer for the Union of Students in Ireland (USI) and represents a number of students’ unions around Ireland, stated that a group of unions was making “very preliminary progress” and had taken advice from a barrister.

Hammond stated that “whilst we are at a very early stage in the process, I would nonetheless expect it to be something that does go ahead”, citing the ongoing issues of interference from institutions that unions are facing. Two motions formalising USI’s commitment to ensuring the autonomy of its member institutions were passed at its national congress last week in Ennis, Co Clare, at which over 350,000 students from the island of Ireland, including Northern Ireland, were represented. In a demonstration of how pressing unions perceive the issue to now be, one motion saw the commitment added into the national union’s constitution for the first time, inserting the wording that “USI shall defend the right of students’ unions

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College Targets Unofficial Tours

Niamh Egleston
DEPUTY NEWS EDITOR

Trinity is hardening its attitude towards unauthorised campus tours visiting the College, and a new policy, set to be introduced this summer, will see College attempt to regulate the tours they fear will “undermine” the university’s brand. The new policy, drafted by the university’s Commercial Revenue

Unit and approved by the College Board on February 22nd, will come into effect this summer, as the College cracks down on unauthorised tours. The proposal, seen by *The University Times*, notes that these tours have seen “significant growth” in recent years, as the number of visitors to the College returns to pre-recession levels of almost two million. The strain such visitors place on the historic campus is a major concern for the College. Last year, speaking to *The University*

Times, Trinity’s Chief Financial Officer (CFO), Ian Mathews, attributed a significant proportion of College’s predicted €34 million deficit for 2015/16 to a rise in infrastructure costs to the university. The Commercial Revenue Unit’s report noted that visitors’ use of campus often leads to “considerable wear and tear”. Every day, various tour guides, companies and operators travel through campus with groups of tourists free of charge. While visitors can sign up for an of-

ficial campus tour, usually provided by current Trinity students, they are under no obligation to do so and many are able to explore campus unobstructed. Tourists and visitors can enjoy the various campus services, including bathrooms, cafés and shops. However, many do not use the official Trinity Tours, or enter the Book of Kells exhibition, for which a fee is charged. Discussion at College Board also noted

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On the Ball



PHOTO BY ANNA MORAN FOR THE UNIVERSITY TIMES

Setup for Trinity Ball begins Saturday morning saw the arrival of equipment for Trinity Ball 2017, with campus due to transform over the next week in anticipation of the biggest night in the College calendar on Friday.

DUCAC Reserves Dwindle by 90%

Jake O'Donnell
DEPUTY SPORTS EDITOR

After incurring a deficit every year for the last six years, Dublin University Central Athletics Club (DUCAC) risks running out of cash. Accounts seen by *The University Times* show cash reserves have decreased by 93.5 per cent over the last six years. DUCAC, the governing body of student sport in Trinity, has seen its cash reserves fall from

just over €337,300 in 2011 to now just over €22,000 in 2016. While the accounts are meant to be available to view by any student, *The University Times*, after months of emailing with DUCAC, the Department of Sport, the Capitalisation Committee and Trinity’s Financial Services Division, finally obtained the accounts through a Freedom of Information (FOI) request. This came months after being told by the Senior Dean, Prof Brian McGing, who chairs the Capitalisations Committee, in an email to *The University Times*, that “there is

nothing secret” about the DUCAC accounts and that they should be available “direct from DUCAC”. The accounts reveal the organisation’s dwindling cash reserves, as well as hinting at the main causes behind DUCAC’s combined deficit of over €320,000 over the last six years. Their committed contribution of €250,000 towards the new Trinity Sport development at the Santry sports grounds has also been a huge strain on DUCAC’s finances, the accounts show. The deficits have shown no clear signs of abating, with the

2016 financial year actually producing the largest deficit of the last six at just over €87,400. After receiving a transfer of €125,000 from the accounts of the Pavilion Bar (the Pav), DUCAC recorded a surplus of €86,000 in 2015. This €125,000 from the Pav, though, was put towards paying off the €250,000 for the development of Santry Sports, which ultimately led to a final DUCAC deficit of €38,935 for the year. Last year, DUCAC contrib-

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Trinity’s Growing Efforts to Attract International Students

Jenna Clarke-Molloy examines Trinity’s efforts to recruit students from outside the EU, through open days, school visits and alumni **PAGE 8**»



College’s Sweetest Startup on Making Irish Marshmallows

Ellen McLean speaks to the Trinity students behind a new startup that hopes to compete with the biggest confectionary brands **PAGE 8**»



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